"No one will ever want me."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Rejection in dating, a breakup, or years of watching friends pair off can feel like a final judgment. Earlier messages about looks, weight, family, or worth can make every unreturned message sound like confirmation. Over time, we may stop trying, or we settle for less than we deserve out of fear.

What Scripture teaches

God says, "Because you are precious and honored in My sight, and because I love you." The psalmist says, "You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother's womb. I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made." The LORD "will rejoice over you with gladness." These verses are not a guarantee of marriage. They do settle the question of whether you are wanted: you are wanted by the God who made you. A season without a partner is not a verdict about your worth or your future.

> *"Because you are precious and honored in My sight, and because I love you, I will give men in exchange for you and nations in place of your life"* (Isaiah 43:4).

Also see

> "For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother's womb. I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well" (Psalm 139:13–14).

> "The LORD your God is among you; He is mighty to save. He will rejoice over you with gladness; He will quiet you with His love; He will rejoice over you with singing" (Zephaniah 3:17).

> "For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope" (Jeremiah 29:11).

> "Delight yourself in the LORD, and He will give you the desires of your heart" (Psalm 37:4).

Common self-statements

- I am unattractive and unlovable.
- Everyone else finds someone but me.
- Nobody has ever really wanted me.
- I will end up alone.
- I do not have anything to offer.
- The next rejection will prove it.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting that no one will ever want me.
- Overgeneralizing: Treating past rejections as a rule for my whole future.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling unwanted and concluding that I am.
- Labeling: Calling myself unlovable.

Challenging questions

- What experiences led me to think no one will ever want me?

- Has anyone ever shown interest, friendship, or care?
- Is the lack of a partner right now the same as being unwantable?
- What do I like and value about myself?
- How does God see me?
- What would I tell a friend in my place?

Truth summary

> I am precious and honored in God's sight. Not having a partner right now does not mean I am unwanted or unworthy. I can live fully now, build good friendships, and hope without needing to prove my worth.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Loneliness
- Love, By God
- Marriage Guidance
- Hopeless

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "No one will ever want me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"No one will ever want me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What led me to this belief?
- ☐ Who values me?
- ☐ What do I like about myself?
- ☐ What does God say about me?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend?
- ☐ How can I invest in friends?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am precious and honored in God's sight.
- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ God rejoices over me.
- ☐ Rejection is not a verdict.
- ☐ My life has value now.
- ☐ I can hope without despair.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Isaiah 43:4**
  "Because you are precious and honored in My sight, and because I love you, I will give men in exchange for you and nations in place of your life."
- ☐ **Psalm 139:13–14**
  "For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother's womb. I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."
- ☐ **Zephaniah 3:17**
  "The LORD your God is among you; He is mighty to save. He will rejoice over you with gladness; He will quiet you with His love; He will rejoice over you with singing."

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Wanted by God: Each day, write one thing about yourself that is good and one sign that someone values you.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Isaiah 43:4 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I am precious and honored in God's sight, whatever happens in dating.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Gather the evidence. List people who value or enjoy you, as friends or family.
- [ ] Name the voice. Write who first told you that you were unwantable.
- [ ] Invest in friendships. Spend time with people who enjoy you.
- [ ] Read Isaiah 43:4. Say it aloud each morning.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "No one will ever want me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Valued today
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~No one will ever want me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You say I am precious and honored. Heal the pain of rejection, and help me live fully now. Give me hope and peace whatever the future holds. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

INTERPERSONAL FALSE BELIEF #37 · DATING AND SINGLENESS

"I'm single because something is wrong with me."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

In a culture and sometimes a church that treats marriage as the normal goal, a single adult can feel like a puzzle others are trying to solve. Well-meaning questions, such as "Why aren't you married yet?" can leave us scanning ourselves for defects. We may blame our personality, looks, past, or faith.

What Scripture teaches

Paul writes, "Each man has his own gift from God; one has this gift, another has that," speaking of marriage and singleness alike. The psalmist says, "I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works." Paul adds that "you have been made complete in Christ." Many people are single for reasons that have nothing to do with a flaw: timing, circumstances, opportunities, or calling. Singleness is not a symptom, and a spouse is not a certificate of normal.

> *"I wish that all men were as I am. But each man has his own gift from God; one has this gift, another has that"* (1 Corinthians 7:7).

Also see

> "For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother's womb. I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well" (Psalm 139:13–14).

> "And you have been made complete in Christ, who is the head over every ruler and authority" (Colossians 2:10).

> "For there are eunuchs who were born that way; others were made that way by men; and still others live like eunuchs for the sake of the kingdom of heaven. The one who can accept this should accept it" (Matthew 19:12).

> "For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope" (Jeremiah 29:11).

Common self-statements

- There must be a reason no one chose me.
- I am too much, or not enough.
- Everyone else sees my flaws.
- If I fix myself, I will find someone.
- Something about me pushes people away.
- I am defective.

Common logical errors

- Personalization: Taking sole blame for circumstances with many causes.
- Labeling: Calling myself defective.
- Mind reading: Assuming others see me as flawed.
- Magical thinking: Believing that fixing myself will guarantee a partner.

Challenging questions

- What reasons for being single are outside my control?

- Do I know happily married people who are no more “fixed” than I am?
- Do I know content, healthy single people?
- What have I been told, and by whom, about being single?
- What does God say about gifts and callings?
- What would living well in this season look like?

Truth summary

> Being single is not a diagnosis. God made me with purpose, and I am complete in Christ. I can grow in healthy ways without believing I am broken, and I can live this season with meaning and joy.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Marriage Guidance
- Gifts, Spiritual
- Will of God
- Thinking, Unhealthy

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

Truth Be Told — Matthew West featuring Carly Pearce
Honesty about struggles makes room for grace and support instead of pretending to be fine.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God’s loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Amazing Grace — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn locates salvation and sustaining hope in grace rather than merit.

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm single because something is wrong with me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm single because something is wrong with me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What factors affect my relationships?
- ☐ What have I been told?
- ☐ What is true?
- ☐ What does it mean to be complete in Christ?
- ☐ What makes my life full?
- ☐ Who can I serve?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Singleness is not a defect.
- ☐ I am complete in Christ.
- ☐ God has gifts and purposes for me.
- ☐ Many reasons for singleness are not about me.
- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ I can live well now.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 1 Corinthians 7:7
  "I wish that all men were as I am. But each man has his own gift from God; one has this gift, another has that."
- ☐ Colossians 2:10
  "And you have been made complete in Christ, who is the head over every ruler and authority."
- ☐ Psalm 139:13–14
  "For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother's womb. I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Whole and living: Each week, note one thing you did that made your life full, whatever your relationship status.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Colossians 2:10 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I am complete in Christ, not defective.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] List the factors. Write the circumstances that have affected your relationships.
- [ ] Answer the voices. Write the comments you have heard and a truthful response.
- [ ] Build a full life. Plan friendships, service, and interests.
- [ ] Memorize Colossians 2:10. Say it when doubt arises.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm single because something is wrong with me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A full life
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm single because something is wrong with me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have asked what is wrong with me. Thank You that I am complete in Christ. Heal the sting of comments, and help me live this season with purpose and joy. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

"I'm too old to find love."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Birthdays can feel like a closing door. A culture that celebrates youth, a divorce or widowhood in later years, or a long season of waiting can convince us that love is for the young. Dating can seem harder when we carry history, children, or health concerns.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture tells of people for whom God did good things late in life. Sarah "conceived and bore a son to Abraham in his old age, at the very time God had promised," and the angel told Mary that Elizabeth "has conceived a son in her old age… For no word from God will ever fail." The psalmist says that in God's presence "You will fill me with joy." These stories do not promise marriage, but they show that age does not limit God. Love, companionship, and purpose can come at any age, and joy does not have to wait.

> *"Look, even Elizabeth your relative has conceived a son in her old age, and she who was called barren is in her sixth month. For no word from God will ever fail"* (Luke 1:36–37).

Also see

> "So Sarah conceived and bore a son to Abraham in his old age, at the very time God had promised" (Genesis 21:2).

> "You have made known to me the path of life; You will fill me with joy in Your presence, with eternal pleasures at Your right hand" (Psalm 16:11).

> "For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope" (Jeremiah 29:11).

> "Instead of shame, My people will have a double portion, and instead of humiliation, they will rejoice in their share; and so they will inherit a double portion in their land, and everlasting joy will be theirs" (Isaiah 61:7).

Common self-statements

- That ship has sailed.
- No one wants someone my age.
- All the good ones are taken.
- I missed my chance.
- It is too late to start over.
- Love is for younger people.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting that love is no longer possible.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing love is either youthful or impossible.
- Overgeneralizing: Assuming everyone thinks like the culture's stereotypes.
- Discounting the positive: Ignoring couples who found love later in life.

Challenging questions

- Do I know anyone who found love or companionship later in life?

- What do I have to offer at this stage that I did not before?
- What am I afraid of in trying again?
- What would a good, realistic hope look like?
- What does Scripture say about God's timing?
- How can I build joy and companionship now, regardless of romance?

Truth summary

> Age is not a barrier to God's goodness or to love. I cannot promise how my story will unfold, but I can hope with open hands, build friendship and purpose now, and trust God's timing.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Will of God
- Marriage Guidance
- Elderly
- Loneliness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Depression
- Trouble/Hardship

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Do It Again — Steven Curtis Chapman
God's repeated gifts and new mercies express His continuing love.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm too old to find love"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm too old to find love." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who found love later in life?
- ☐ What do I offer now?
- ☐ What am I afraid of?
- ☐ What is a realistic hope?
- ☐ What builds joy now?
- ☐ Where can I meet people?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God's word does not fail.
- ☐ Age does not limit God.
- ☐ He fills me with joy in His presence.
- ☐ Love can come at any age.
- ☐ Companionship takes many forms.
- ☐ I can live with hope.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Luke 1:36–37**
  "Look, even Elizabeth your relative has conceived a son in her old age, and she who was called barren is in her sixth month. For no word from God will ever fail."
- ☐ **Psalm 16:11**
  "You have made known to me the path of life; You will fill me with joy in Your presence, with eternal pleasures at Your right hand."
- ☐ **Jeremiah 29:11**
  "For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope."

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Open hands: Each week, record one step you took with hope and one that built joy now.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Luke 1:36–37 becomes: "Sarah can write: "No word from God will ever fail, and age does not limit Him.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Collect stories. Ask older couples how they met, or read such stories.
- [ ] Take a healthy step. Join a group, class, or community where you can meet people.
- [ ] Build friendships. Invest in companions of all ages.
- [ ] Pray with open hands. Offer your hopes to God and thank Him for today.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm too old to find love": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Hope with open hands
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm too old to find love.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, my age has felt like a door closing. You are not limited by years. Give me hope, joy, and wisdom, and lead me in the way You choose. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

"I need a partner to be complete."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Songs, movies, and even sermons can suggest that one is half a person until paired up. After a breakup or in a long single season, loneliness can feel like proof. Some of us have also learned to look to a partner to fill emptiness only God can fill, and that can put an impossible burden on any relationship.

What Scripture teaches

Paul writes of Christ, "You have been made complete in Christ, who is the head over every ruler and authority." He says that marriage and singleness are both gifts. The psalmist says, "You have made known to me the path of life; You will fill me with joy in Your presence." And God promises, "My God will supply all your needs according to His glorious riches in Christ Jesus." A partner can be a wonderful gift, but no person can complete us. If we expect them to, we set both of us up to be disappointed.

> *"And you have been made complete in Christ, who is the head over every ruler and authority"* (Colossians 2:10).

Also see

> "I wish that all men were as I am. But each man has his own gift from God; one has this gift, another has that" (1 Corinthians 7:7).

> "You have made known to me the path of life; You will fill me with joy in Your presence, with eternal pleasures at Your right hand" (Psalm 16:11).

> "And my God will supply all your needs according to His glorious riches in Christ Jesus" (Philippians 4:19).

> "For your husband is your Maker— the LORD of Hosts is His name— the Holy One of Israel is your Redeemer; He is called the God of all the earth" (Isaiah 54:5).

Common self-statements

- I am only half a person alone.
- I will not be happy until I have someone.
- I cannot cope on my own.
- A partner would fix my emptiness.
- Being single is a lesser life.
- I need someone to be whole.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either complete with a partner or incomplete without.
- Magical thinking: Believing a partner will solve my emptiness.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling lonely and concluding that I am incomplete.
- Should statements: Insisting that I should be partnered by now.

Challenging questions

- What do I hope a partner would give me, and what does Scripture say about where those needs are met?

- Have I seen partnered people who are still unfulfilled?
- What strengths do I have that make me whole as I am?
- What would it look like to be content and open at the same time?
- What does being complete in Christ mean for me?
- How can I enjoy life and relationships now?

Truth summary

> I am complete in Christ. A partner would be a gift, not a missing piece. I can enjoy my life, build deep friendships, and be open to love without making any person responsible for making me whole.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Marriage Guidance
- Loneliness
- God, All Loving
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Joy

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Love
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Oh My Soul — Casting Crowns
Honest distress can coexist with faith and hope in God.

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

Forever — Kari Jobe
Christ's resurrection grounds hope in His victory over sin and death.

Amazing Grace — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn locates salvation and sustaining hope in grace rather than merit.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I need a partner to be complete"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I need a partner to be complete." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I want a partner to give me?
- ☐ Where else can those needs be met?
- ☐ What does complete in Christ mean?
- ☐ Who are my close friends?
- ☐ What brings me joy now?
- ☐ How can I be open and content?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am complete in Christ.
- ☐ Marriage and singleness are both gifts.
- ☐ God fills me with joy in His presence.
- ☐ God supplies my needs.
- ☐ No partner can complete me.
- ☐ I can be whole and open to love.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Colossians 2:10**
  "And you have been made complete in Christ, who is the head over every ruler and authority."
- ☐ **Psalm 16:11**
  "You have made known to me the path of life; You will fill me with joy in Your presence, with eternal pleasures at Your right hand."
- ☐ **Philippians 4:19**
  "And my God will supply all your needs according to His glorious riches in Christ Jesus."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Whole in Christ: Each week, note one time you felt content or full without a partner.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Colossians 2:10 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I have been made complete in Christ.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Loneliness" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] List what you hope for. Write what you want a partner to provide.
- [ ] Notice other sources. Beside each, write how God and friends can meet it.
- [ ] Build deep friendships. Invest in a few close relationships.
- [ ] Pray Psalm 16:11. Ask God to fill you with joy.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I need a partner to be complete": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Whole today
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I need a partner to be complete.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I have looked for someone else to complete me. Thank You that I am complete in Christ. Fill the empty places with Your presence, and prepare me to love well, whether single or married. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

“God is keeping me single because he is displeased with me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

When we pray for a partner and nothing happens, it is tempting to wonder whether God is withholding it. If we carry guilt over our past, it is easy to link the two. Some teaching also pictures marriage as a reward for faithfulness, which leaves single people feeling they have failed a test.

What Scripture teaches

Paul writes, “There is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus.” “God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us.” The Lord says, “I know the plans I have for you… plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope,” and Paul calls singleness a gift, as marriage is. Scripture never presents marriage as a prize for good behavior or singleness as a punishment. Many faithful people, including Paul, were single.

> *“Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus”* (Romans 8:1).

Also see

> “But God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us” (Romans 5:8).

> “For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope” (Jeremiah 29:11).

> “I wish that all men were as I am. But each man has his own gift from God; one has this gift, another has that” (1 Corinthians 7:7).

> “Delight yourself in the LORD, and He will give you the desires of your heart” (Psalm 37:4).

Common self-statements

- God is holding out on me.
- He is punishing me for my past.
- I did not pray right.
- He gives spouses to people who are better than me.
- I am being tested and failing.
- God must be angry with me.

Common logical errors

- Mind reading: Assuming I know God’s motive from my circumstances.
- Magical thinking: Believing marriage is a reward for good behavior.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling lonely and concluding that God is angry.
- Personalization: Treating my situation as God’s response to my sin.

Challenging questions

- What do I believe I did to deserve this?
- Have I confessed it, and what does Scripture say about forgiveness?

- Were there faithful single people in Scripture?
- Is God's love measured by relationship status?
- What does Jeremiah 29:11 mean in a season of waiting?
- How can I serve and grow today?

Truth summary

> There is no condemnation for me in Christ. God's love for me was proven at the cross, not by my relationship status. Singleness is not a punishment, and I can trust God with my future while living fully today.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Guilt/Shame
- God, All Loving
- Will of God
- Marriage Guidance
- Forgiveness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Trouble/Hardship

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Songs that speak truth to this belief

Forgiveness — Matthew West
Ask God for help releasing resentment while working through real hurt.

This Is Amazing Grace — Phil Wickham
Christ bears the burden of rescue rather than demanding self-salvation.

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

Amazing Grace — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn locates salvation and sustaining hope in grace rather than merit.

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Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"God is keeping me single because he is displeased with me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Why do I think God is displeased?
- ☐ Have I confessed?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about singleness?
- ☐ How has God shown love?
- ☐ How can I serve now?
- ☐ What can I trust God with?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ There is no condemnation for me.
- ☐ God loved me while I was a sinner.
- ☐ Marriage is not a reward.
- ☐ Singleness can be a gift.
- ☐ God's plans are for my good.
- ☐ I can trust Him while I wait.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Romans 8:1
  "Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."
- ☐ Romans 5:8
  "But God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us."
- ☐ Jeremiah 29:11
  "For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ No condemnation: Each time you think "God is displeased," write Romans 8:1 and one sign of His love.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Romans 8:1 becomes: "Sarah can write: "There is no condemnation for me in Christ Jesus.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
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6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Name the fear. Write why you think God is displeased.
- ☐ Confess and receive. If there is sin, confess it and receive forgiveness.
- ☐ Look at Paul's life. Read how Paul describes singleness.
- ☐ Serve someone. Put your gifts to use this week.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

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What I learned: _____

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Thu				
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Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

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My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~God is keeping me single because he is displeased with me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

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Prayer

Lord, I have wondered if You are displeased with me. Thank You that there is no condemnation in Christ. Give me peace in this season, and help me serve You with joy. Amen.

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